Typography

Serif faces under open licences, downloaded from their makers' repositories and served from our own domain. No requests go to Google's font service.

What "no Google Fonts" means here

Fonts are fetched from each project's own repository and self-hosted with next/font/local. Google's catalogue now includes many open fonts, Libertinus and Charis SIL among them, so catalogue status is listed for each face; it does not affect licence or hosting.

Requirements

Readable prose at 16 to 18 px; interface text at 12 to 14 px; true italics for narration; a semibold or bold for labels; clear numerals for HP, AP, and times; Latin coverage for invented names; small files.

Faces tried

Source Serif 4, Charis SIL, Libertinus, Junicode 2, and ET Book. Each is set in the same specimen on a Graphite light page with the lavender accent, at true size.

At a glance

Source Serif 4	The lift hums awake below.	**Starting room Publish**
Charis SIL	The lift hums awake below.	**Starting room Publish**
Libertinus	The lift hums awake below.	**Starting room Publish**
Junicode 2	The lift hums awake below.	Starting room Publish
ET Book	The lift hums awake below.	Starting room Publish

Source Serif 4

Frank Grießhammer, Adobe. SIL OFL 1.1.

Source	github.com/adobe-fonts/source-serif
Licence	SIL OFL 1.1
Styles	Variable weight 200 to 900 and optical size 8 to 60 pt, with italics
x-height	0.475 em
Web size	30 KB Latin, per style
Google Fonts	Also listed in the Google Fonts catalogue

The Sunken Archive

Find the core

The panel wakes under Rook's keycard. Somewhere behind the bulkhead, a lift begins to climb, and the water in the stacks moves against the doors as patiently as it has for forty years.

The archivist points toward the lift, and says nothing about the sabotage.

Starting room

airlock

Publish

Add rule

1 Unknown item

reactor_cor is not in this adventure or its settings.

Saved 12:41

0123456789 7/10 HP 8 AP Round 4, 1:42 left

Il1| O0o rn m cl d Rook, Vale, Ash, Ångström, Łódź

Suits Margin because

- Optical sizes: the Caption cut is sturdier and wider for 11 to 13 px interface text, so one family can set the whole app.
- Large x-height and open counters read well on screen at body sizes.
- The deepest family here: weights, italics, tabular and old-style figures, small caps.

Watch for

- Widely used; it reads as competent rather than particular.
- Optical sizes need either the variable font (one file per style, about 120 KB subset) or several static files.

Charis SIL

SIL International, after Matthew Carter's Charter. SIL OFL 1.1.

Source	github.com/silnrsi/font-charis
Licence	SIL OFL 1.1
Styles	Regular, Italic, Bold, Bold Italic (version 7 adds Medium and SemiBold)
x-height	0.482 em
Web size	30 KB Latin, per style
Google Fonts	Also listed in the Google Fonts catalogue

The Sunken Archive

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Il1| O0o rn m cl d Rook, Vale, Ash, Ångström, Łódź

Suits Margin because

- Charter was drawn for low-resolution output; its flat serifs and big x-height survive small sizes and dark mode.
- Sober and matter-of-fact: a good fit for interface text as well as prose.
- Exceptional language coverage for player names and invented words with diacritics.

Watch for

- Few weights in the stable release; headings rely on Bold.
- Plain at display sizes; titles need size, not style, to carry them.

Libertinus

Philipp H. Poll (Linux Libertine), Khaled Hosny, Caleb Maclennan. SIL OFL 1.1.

Source	github.com/alerque/libertinus
Licence	SIL OFL 1.1
Styles	Serif in Regular, Semibold, Bold with italics; Serif Display; Sans; Mono; Math
x-height	0.429 em
Web size	24 KB Latin, per style
Google Fonts	Also listed in the Google Fonts catalogue (since 2025)

The Sunken Archive

Find the core

The panel wakes under Rook's keycard. Somewhere behind the bulkhead, a lift begins to climb, and the water in the stacks moves against the doors as patiently as it has for forty years.

The archivist points toward the lift, and says nothing about the sabotage.

Starting room

airlock Publish Add rule

1 Unknown item Saved 12:41

reactor_cor is not in this adventure or its settings.

0123456789 7/10 HP 8 AP Round 4, 1:42 left

Il1| O0o rn m cl d Rook, Vale, Ash, Ångström, Łódź

Suits Margin because

- A whole superfamily from one source: book serif, an Optima-like sans for controls, and a matching mono for YAML.
- Nineteenth-century book character suits a manuscript metaphor without pastiche.
- Smallest files of the set.

Watch for

- Smaller x-height: body text needs 17 px to match the others at 16 px.
- The sans has only Regular, Italic, and Bold.

Junicode 2

Peter S. Baker. SIL OFL 1.1.

Source	github.com/psb1558/Junicode-font
Licence	SIL OFL 1.1
Styles	Variable weight 300 to 700 and width 75 to 125, with italics
x-height	0.415 em
Web size	160 KB Latin with all features; much less with features trimmed
Google Fonts	Not yet listed; accepted for onboarding to Google Fonts

The Sunken Archive

Find the core

The panel wakes under Rook's keycard. Somewhere behind the bulkhead, a lift begins to climb, and the water in the stacks moves against the doors as patiently as it has for forty years.

The archivist points toward the lift, and says nothing about the sabotage.

Starting room

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Publish

Add rule

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reactor_cor is not in this adventure or its settings.

Saved 12:41

0123456789 7/10 HP 8 AP Round 4, 1:42 left

Il1| Ooo rn m cl d Rook, Vale, Ash, Ångström, Łódź

Suits Margin because

- A scholar's medieval face: the most atmospheric option for a tabletop game without being a costume font.
- The width axis gives a condensed cut for dense interface rows from the same family.

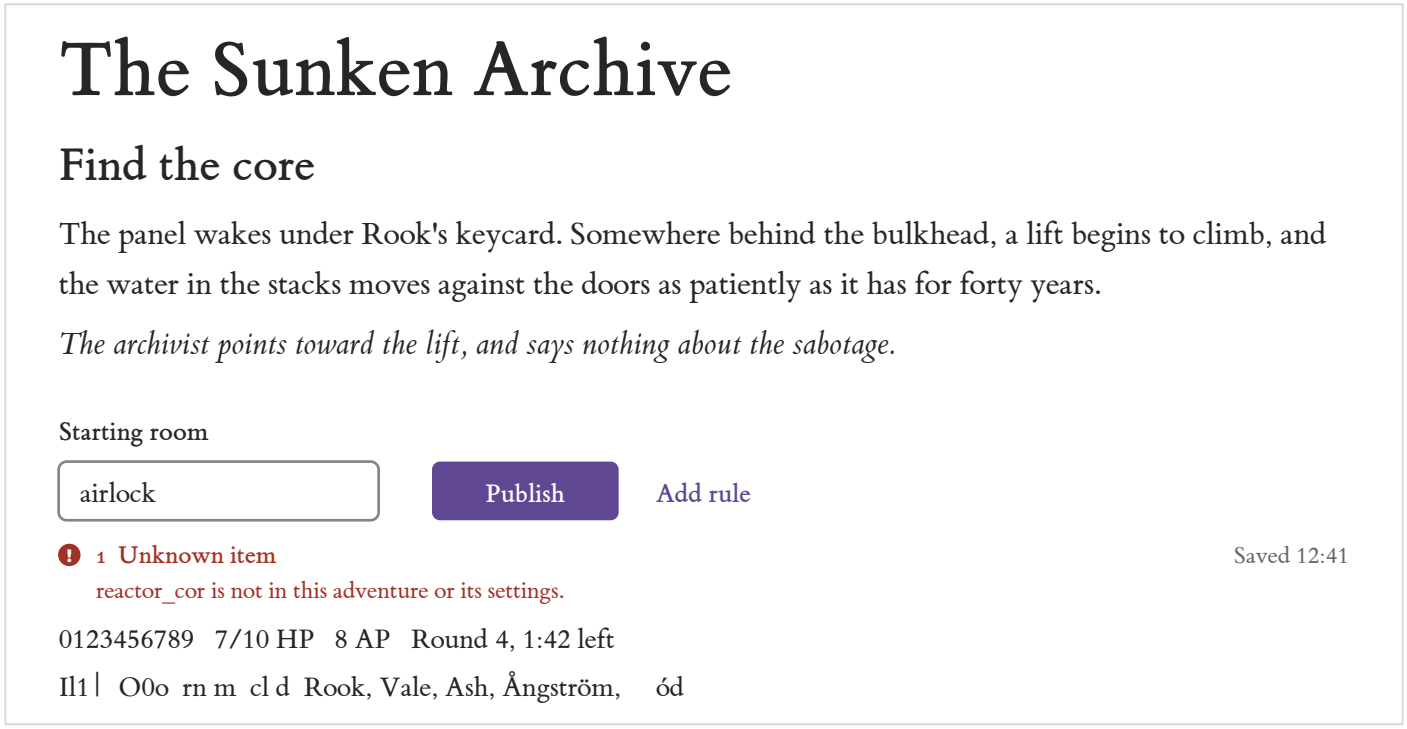
Watch for

- Small x-height and old-style details tire the eye in long interface use.
- Built for medievalists: a very large file unless subset and feature-trimmed.

ET Book

Dmitry Krasny, Bonnie Scranton, Edward Tufte. MIT.

Source	github.com/edwardtufte/et-book
Licence	MIT
Styles	Roman, Italic, Semibold, Bold; lining and old-style figure files
x-height	about 0.40 em
Web size	35 KB Latin, per style
Google Fonts	Not listed in the Google Fonts catalogue



Suits Margin because

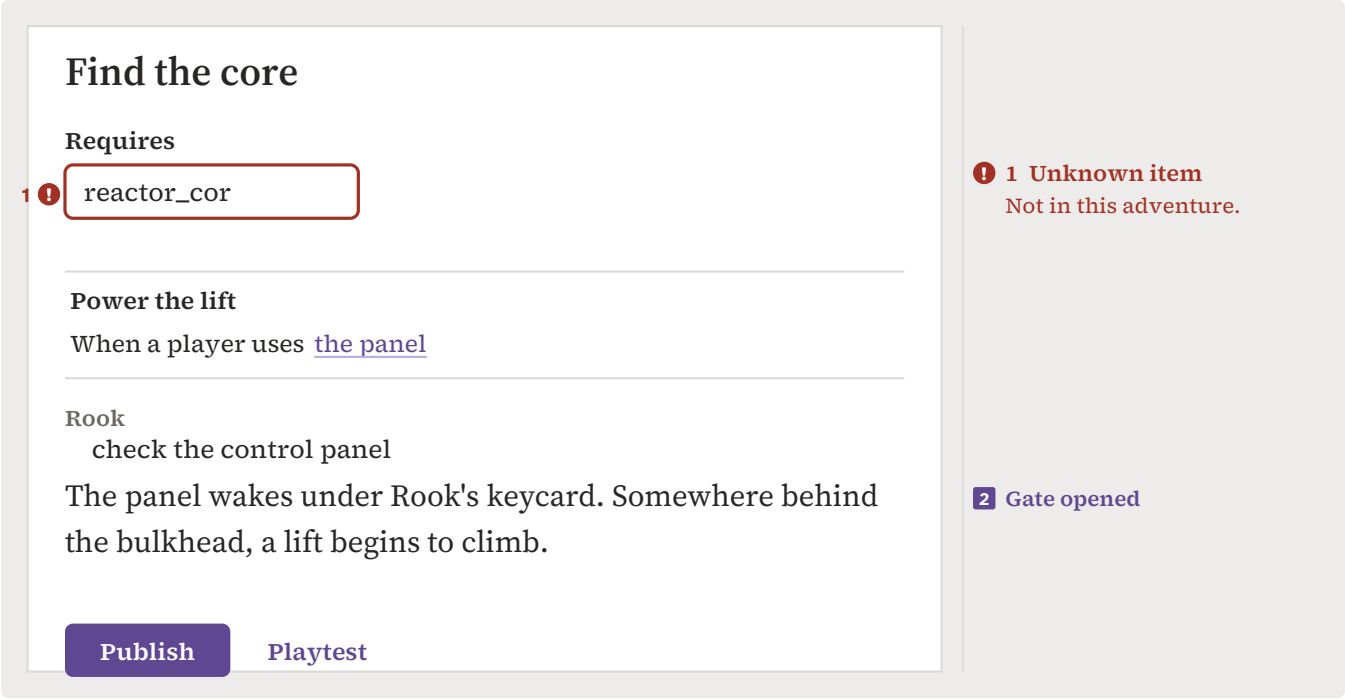
- The face of Tufte's books and Tufte CSS: the origin of the sidenote idea behind Margin's notes.
- Elegant, Bembo-like text with a real semibold.

Watch for

- Its permissive licence has been questioned because the design follows Bembo; check before shipping.
- Limited character set, light colour on screen, and too delicate for interface text.

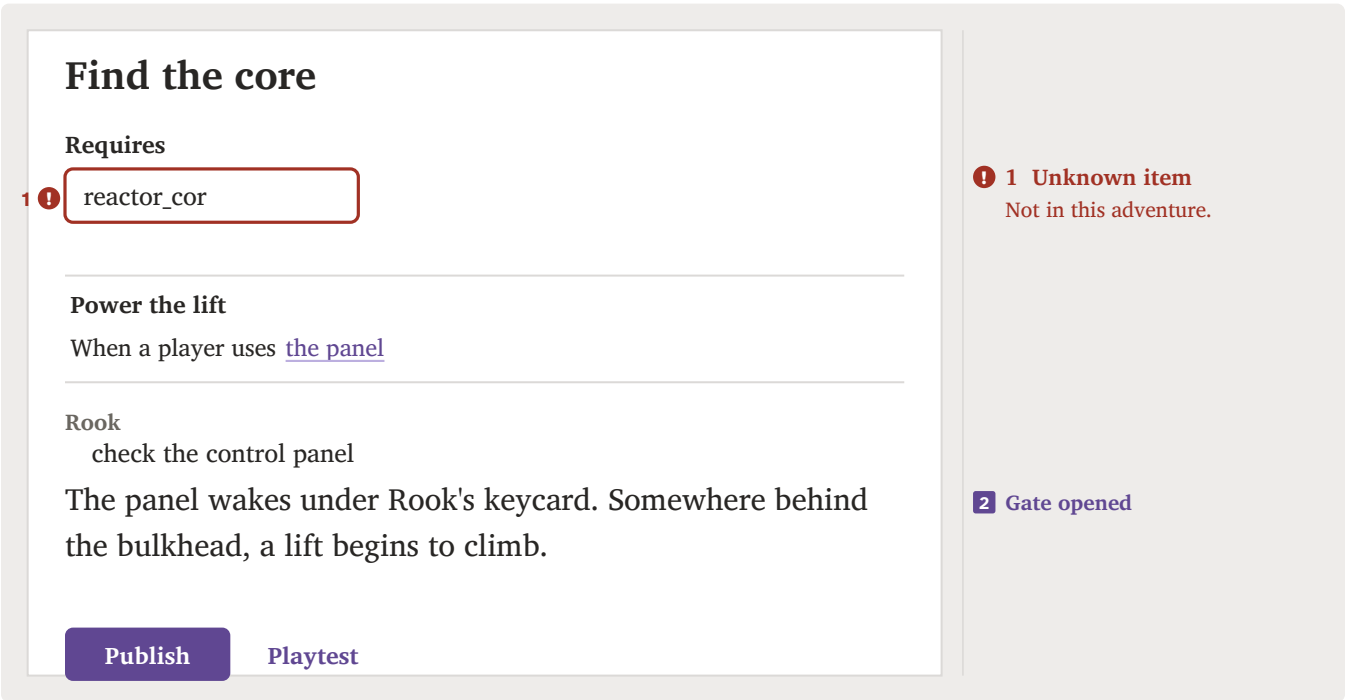
Pairings

Each pairing set in the same editor and play fragment, light mode.



A. Source Serif 4 throughout

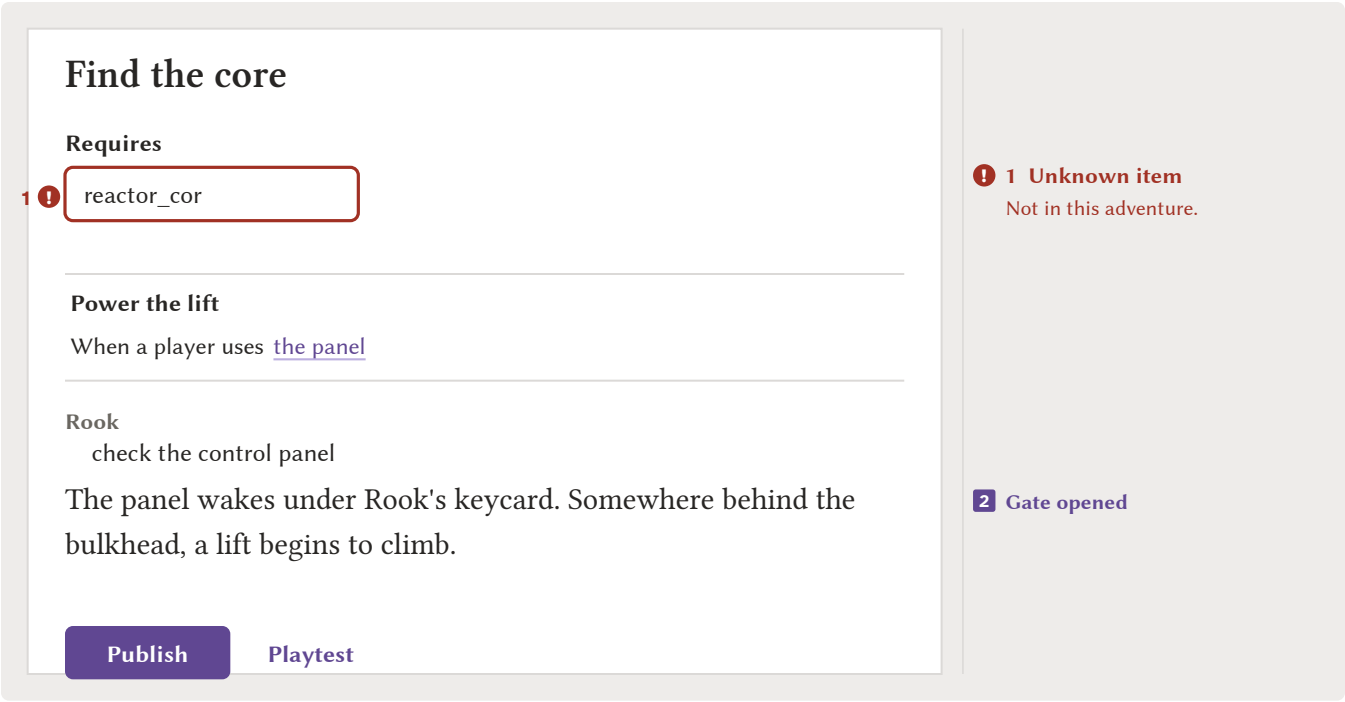
Text cut for prose, Caption cut for controls, Subhead for titles. One family, one licence, one source.



B. Charis SIL throughout

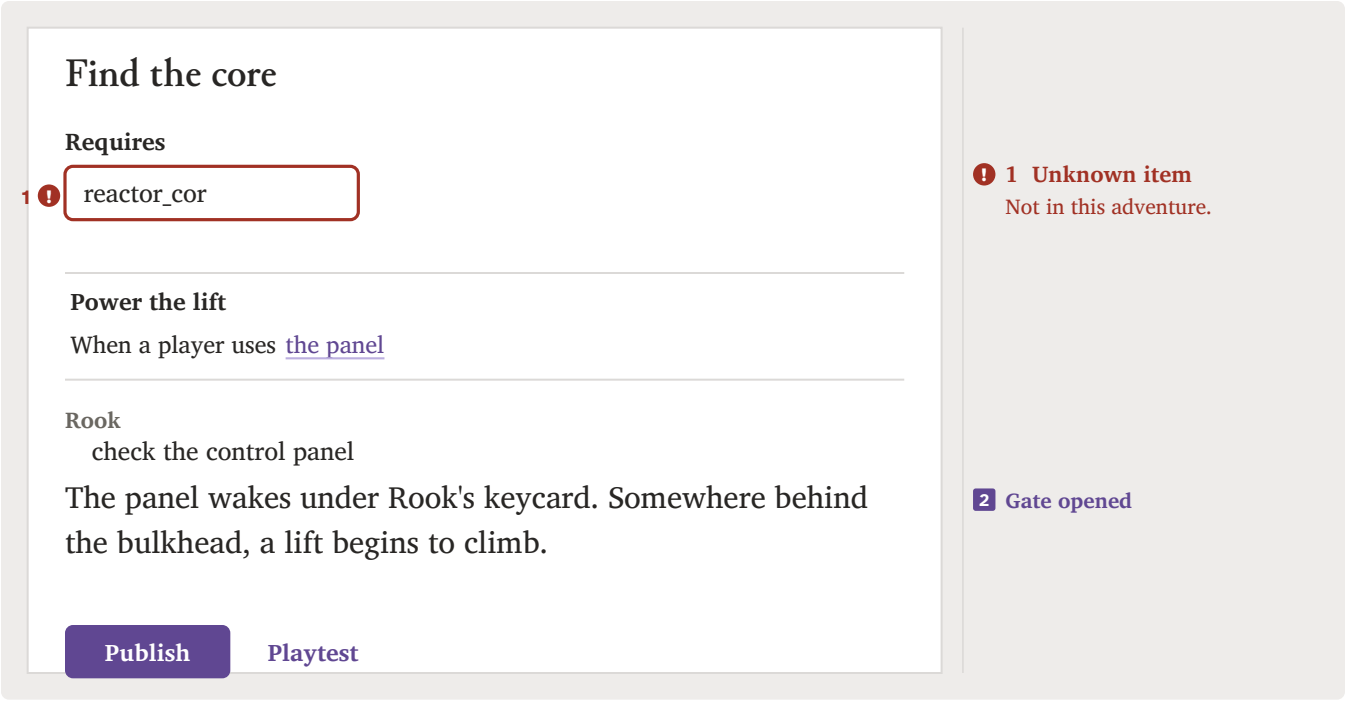
One sturdy face for everything; the plainest and most robust option, strongest in dark mode.

Pairings, continued



C. Libertinus Serif with Libertinus Sans

Book serif for the story, its sans sibling for the software. Keeps Margin's two-voice rule inside one superfamily.

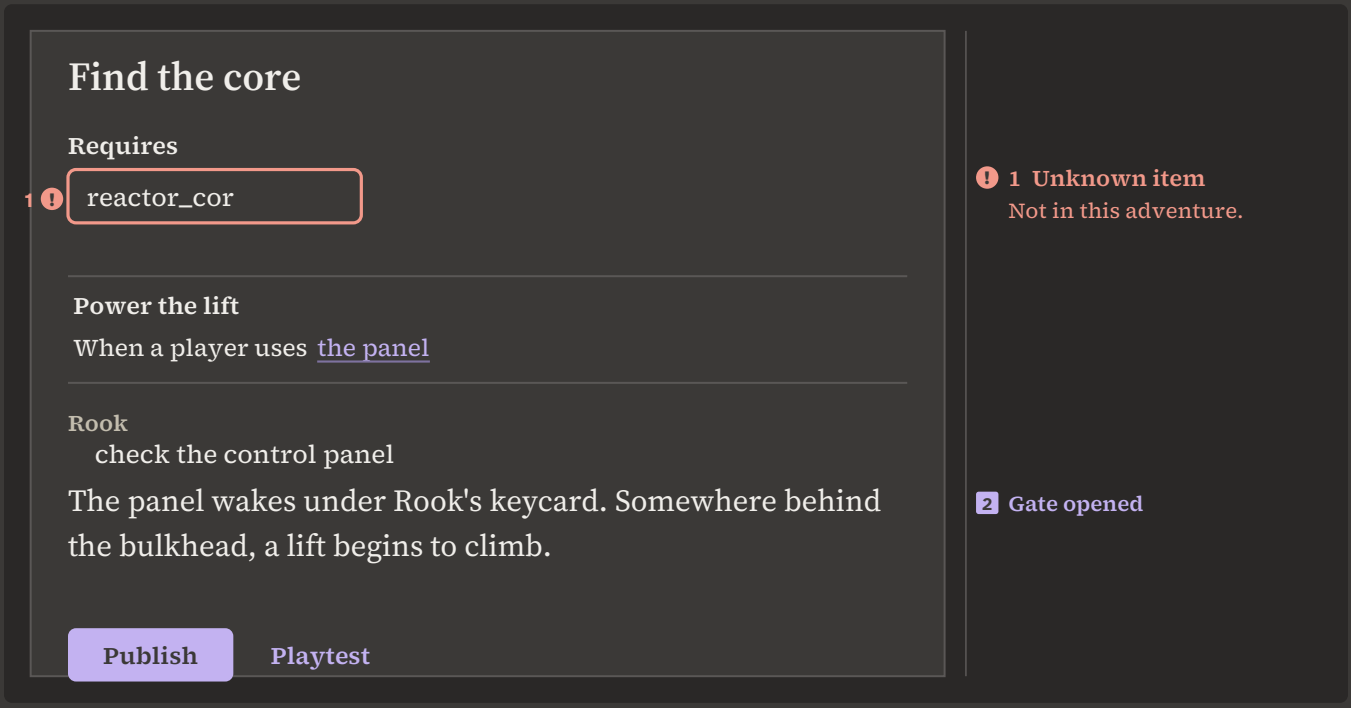


D. Junicode headings, Charis text

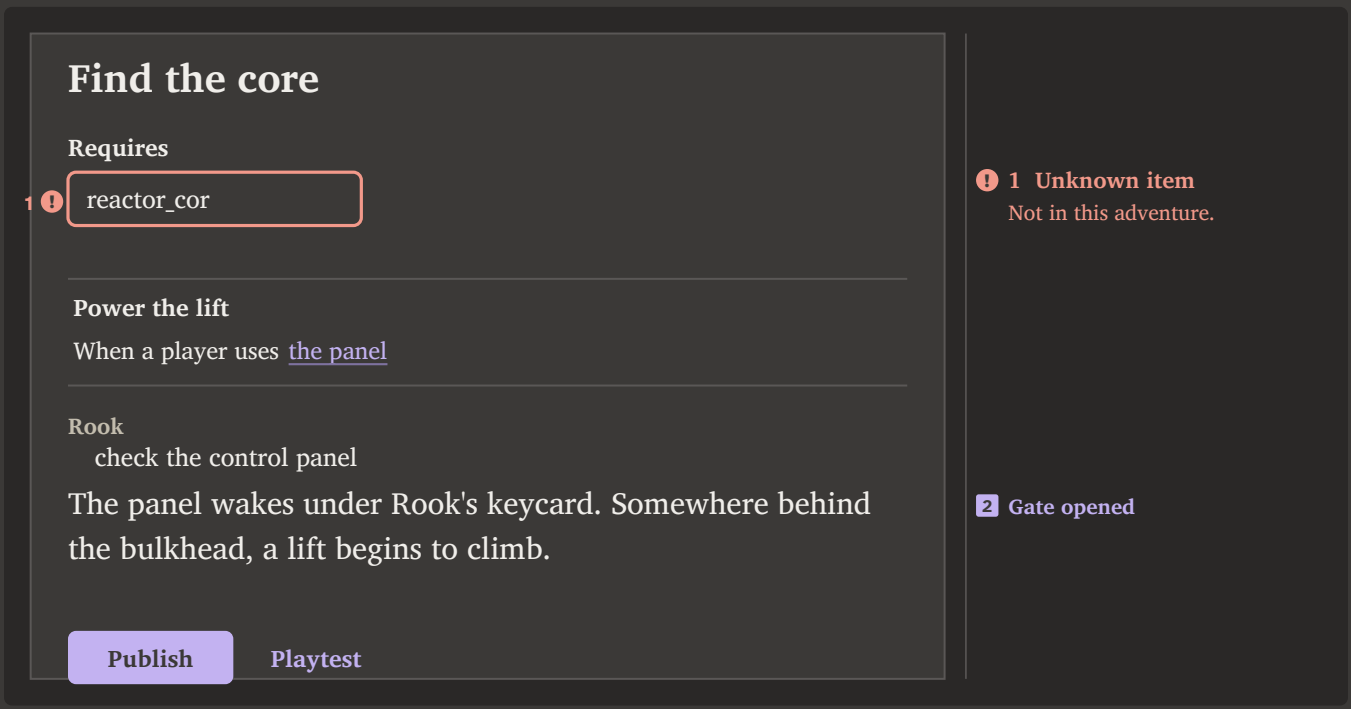
Medieval character in titles only, over a robust text and interface face.

Pairings at night

Serifs thin out on dark grounds. Charis and Source Serif's Caption cut hold up best.



A. Source Serif 4 throughout



B. Charis SIL throughout

Recommendation

Two good answers, depending on how much character the product should carry.

First choice: A, Source Serif 4 throughout

Optical sizes solve the problem serifs usually have in interfaces: the Caption cut is made for 11 to 13 px. One variable font with italics covers prose, controls, and titles, with tabular figures for HP and timers. Margin's two voices become two optical sizes of one family, and notes stay in the interface size.

If more character is wanted: C, Libertinus

A book serif with its own sans and mono, the smallest files, and the most literary feel. Set body text at 17 px to make up for the smaller x-height.

Keep in reserve

Charis SIL as a fallback for dark mode or accessibility settings; Junicode for display only, such as adventure titles on the cover page of a published adventure.

Do not ship

ET Book, until its licence is confirmed with its authors.

Setting it up

1. Download releases from the upstream repositories; keep each OFL.txt or LICENSE beside the files.
2. Subset to Latin plus punctuation and arrows with pyftsubset, keeping kerning, ligatures, tnum, onum, and smcp; output WOFF2.
3. Load with next/font/local, font-display swap, and preload only the body and interface styles.
4. List the fonts and licences on the attribution page with the other third-party notices.
5. Use tabular figures (font-variant-numeric: tabular-nums) in the round bar, stats, and tables.